

► **Problem:** A liquid such as coffee or Coke spilt on your keyboard, and you need to fix it.

Comments: It is possible in most cases to get a keyboard, to which this has happened, working.

Solution: Immediately turn off the PC and disconnect the keyboard. Then, drain all the liquid from the keyboard by shaking it. If the fluid in the keyboard was not plain water, rinse the keyboard out using plain water, preferably distilled water. Then, rinse out the keyboard using distilled alcohol. This will force the water out of the keyboard and allow it to dry better. Wait until the keyboard is thoroughly dry; this may take two or three days even. The keyboard should then be usable, but don't try to plug it in unless you're sure it is thoroughly dry.

This procedure is not foolproof, and can destroy the keyboard; of course, not doing it will, in many cases, mean the keyboard is destroyed anyway. If the spill was just water, and you don't want to use alcohol, you may be able to just wait for the water to evaporate. This can take a lot of time.

► **Problem:** One or more of the keys on your keyboard is sticking, bouncing, repeating, or not generating a keystroke reliably.

Comments: Sometimes, on older keyboards and/or ones that have seen a lot of use, keys may stick when you press them down (and refuse to pop back up), or they may cause bouncing or repeating (more than one character showing up after pressing a key only once). Sometimes a key may not generate a keystroke the first time it is pressed and may have to be pressed down hard in order to recognise.

Cause: These problems are usually caused by dirt and debris within the keyboard, and can usually be fixed. On very old keyboards, these symptoms can just generally be a sign of wear-out of the internal mechanisms.

Solution #1: If the problem is that of keys repeating, and this happens on many different keys on the keyboard, then this may not be a physical problem but rather the "typematic" setting. This is a feature that causes a keystroke to repeat automatically when you hold the key down. Check in your BIOS and in the Keyboard sec-